Although you'll primarily work with Rideshare, try creating another database. Make one that will be dedicated for experimentation. This will give you another place to experiment with schema modifications, bulk loading rows, or query performance.

From psql, type `CREATE DATABASE experiments;` to create the new database.

Next you'll create a table in your `experiments` database and populate it with fake data.

Try writing a SQL DDL statement that creates a table `tbl` with a single column `col` of type `smallint`. Normally you might use Active Record to create a table. It's ok to look this up, but try to write it in SQL if you can. If you're making mistakes that's ok, you're practicing and improving, and you're working locally where there's no negative consequences.

Try it yourself or refer to the SQL below for the answer.

How might you insert 10 rows into your new table? You'll need to be familiar with the built-in `GENERATE_SERIES()` function. In PostgreSQL, this function is available and generates integers that you can use for whatever purpose. You might want the integers to act as values for the column. Using arguments, you can populate as many rows as you wish.

The SQL statements below create the table and populate it with rows:

sql/create_table_generate_series.sql

```
-- create the table
CREATE TABLE tbl (col smallint);

-- populate the table
INSERT INTO tbl(col) SELECT GENERATE_SERIES(1, 10);
```

You've now created a new experiments database, a table, and populated it with rows.

What else could you practice as SQL?

As a Ruby on Rails developer, you may not have written `CREATE INDEX` statements in SQL. You've relied on the Active Record `create_index` method to generate the SQL statement for you.

Try creating an index using SQL. In query performance emergencies or even for single-use indexes, connecting to a production database with `psql` and creating an index `CONCURRENTLY` can really help quickly improve query performance and end an emergency. Of course a direct production modification should not be the normal way of working, but it's a good skill to have for when it's needed.